YUSUF ULUTAS

SENIOR PROGRAMMER

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PROFILE

Senior Programmer with over 10 years of commercial game development in C++, C#, Unreal Engine and Unity, focused on UI and gameplay systems, console development and performance optimization. Shipped titles include Warhammer 40,000: Boltgun 2, Tales of the Shire, V Rising and RimWorld Console Edition.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Game Engines: Unreal Engine 4/5, Unity
Languages: C++, C#, JavaScript
Tools and Systems: Perforce, Git, Unreal Insights, FMOD, Gameface
Platforms: PS4, PS5, Xbox One, Xbox Series X|S, Nintendo Switch, PC, iOS, Android
Specialties: Gameplay & UI programming, console certification, performance optimization

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Senior Programmer | Auroch Digital · Bristol, UK | Sep 2023 - Present

- Managed direct reports through one-to-ones, overseeing technical development, conducting performance reviews and setting short, medium, long term goals.
- Conducted code reviews, participated in pair programming and mentored junior/mid programmers.
- Owned engine upgrades to support newer platform SDKs, resolving API and plugin compatibility issues across all supported platforms.
- Investigated and resolved gameplay, UI and input issues across all platforms.

Warhammer 40,000: Boltgun 2 | Unreal Engine 5 | C++ | PC, PS5, Xbox Series X/S

- Refactored the save system, including save data structures, save management logic and related UI screens to support multiple playthroughs.
- Implemented a procedural camera motion system driven by character's hand and weapon movements with settings exposed to designers.
- Updated UI screens, gamepad navigation and input glyphs for PS5,Xbox Series X/S.

Starship Troopers: Ultimate Bug War! | Unreal Engine 5 | C++ | PC, PS5, Xbox Series X/S

- Profiled and optimised Niagara effects using Unreal Insights, moving suitable simulations to the GPU, simplifying selected emitters and configuring effect scalability, culling distances and particle pooling to reduce CPU overhead.
- Implemented Xbox Series X/S and PS5 user authentication and controller handling systems.
- Optimized skeletal animation performance to reduce CPU usage in scenes with large numbers of enemies.
- Co-led Xbox Series X/S and PS5 certification, assessing platform requirements, planning compliance testing and issue resolution. Both passed on their first submission.

Tales of the Shire | Unity | C# | Nintendo Switch

- Developed animation optimization tools to remove redundant keyframes and bake rigging constraints across 500+ animation clips, reducing memory usage and CPU overhead.
- Implemented a VFX management system with particle pooling, distance and significance based prioritization.
- Replaced UniStorm's sky and lighting systems with a custom day and night cycle using a single light source and simplified shaders, reducing CPU and GPU overhead on Nintendo Switch.

V Rising | Unity | C# | PC, PS5

- Extended the existing FMOD audio system for PS5, implementing separate output paths for game audio, the DualSense speaker and audio driven haptics using Sony's controller APIs.
- Integrated haptics into the existing effect system, so vibration fires on the relevant actions and events and designers can use it like any other effect.
- Developed a native C++ plugin with C# bindings for DualSense integration in Unity, including PC support.

Senior Programmer | Double Eleven · Middlesbrough, UK | Feb 2021 - Aug 2023

- Conducted code reviews and mentored junior programmers.
- Investigated performance issues and implemented targeted optimisations across gameplay, UI and input systems for console platforms.

Grounded | Unreal Engine 4 | C++ | PS4, PS5, Nintendo Switch

- Implemented Playstation SDK integration layer for the existing custom save system for PS4 and PS5 without replacing the game's save architecture.
- Investigated bottlenecks for console platforms and prepared optimization plans.

RimWorld Console Edition | Unity | C# | PS4, Xbox One

- Developed a UI management system handling nested menus, navigation history, focus management and screen transitions to support gamepad navigation using Gameface (HTML, CSS, JS).
- Optimized string handling to reduce memory allocations and garbage collection overhead.
- Split map generation across multiple frames to reduce frame stalls on PS4 and Xbox while keeping results identical to PC for the same seed.
- Developed custom UI elements, including scroll boxes, sortable tables, sliders and tooltips using Gameface.

Game Programmer | Gameguru · Istanbul, Turkey | Jun 2019 - Jan 2021

Slap Kings | Unity | C# | iOS, Android

- Sole programmer responsible for gameplay, AI, progression and monetisation from concept to release; the game surpassed 100 million downloads across iOS and Android.

Fruit Clinic | Unity | C# | iOS, Android

- Sole programmer responsible for gameplay, progression and monetisation from concept to release; published by Lion Studios with over 50 million downloads across iOS and Android.

Game Programmer | Savronik · Eskişehir, Turkey | May 2018 - Feb 2019

Unreal Engine 4 | C++ | PC

- Developed gameplay and multiplayer systems in Unreal Engine 4, built networking and simulation testing tools and implemented data visualisation for multiple hardware devices using Redis.

Game Programmer | Mobilecraft · Istanbul, Turkey | Mar 2013 - Feb 2015

Unity | C#, JavaScript | iOS, Android

- Developed gameplay and multiplayer systems in Unity, built Node.js game server systems and implemented UI features in collaboration with designers.

Junior Game Programmer | Ark Game Studios · Eskişehir, Turkey | May 2011 - Feb 2013

Unity | C# | iOS, Android

- Developed gameplay mechanics, core game systems and UI features for mobile games using Unity.

EDUCATION

Eskişehir Osmangazi University — BSc, Computer Education and Instructional Technology | 2017
Vilnius University — Information Technology, Erasmus Exchange | Sep 2016 – Jan 2017